

PDFs) for Linux users. So if you wish to run a Linux Machine, Open Source is clearly the way to go.

Our Pick

Going by the utility and features of both OpenOffice and LibreOffice, both will mostly suffice the needs of a lay user, but we'd pick LibreOffice for its promising features, satisfactory performance rate, and bright-looking future. Additionally, it can be tinkered around with to get your work done, without any requirements of plug-ins.

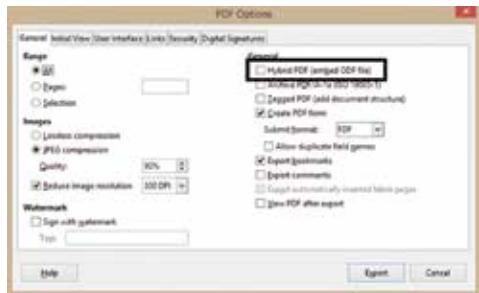
Pros and Cons of LibreOffice

Backed by a solid group of enthusiastic developers, LibreOffice has been developing fast and releasing new versions more frequently, compared to its counterpart, and therefore rapidly being accepted by individuals, corporates and large organizations as a complete replacement to their current PDF suite. The most obvious advantage LibreOffice has over Adobe Acrobat or even Nitro is its pricing, which is null – as opposed to the thousands of bucks users have to pay up to get the latter.

A very subtle, useful feature of LibreOffice, which interestingly, also exists in the latest ver-

sions of Apache OpenOffice and NeoOffice, is the 'Hybrid PDF' functionality. This entails a PDF file which anyone with a PDF reader can view, but thanks to a source document embedded within the file, it needs a modern office suite to make changes or edits. Essentially, what this hybrid PDF file does is save you from keeping two separate file formats – one for viewing and other for editing (PDF and .odf). It is available for sharing and can be viewed with any PDF reader, and edited like an ordinary OpenOffice file. LibreOffice also provides a large range of options when it comes to exporting a file as PDF.

But nothing's perfect, as they say. Even though LibreOffice is a promising piece of software, it isn't as smooth and polished as you would expect



Numerous export options for PDF including Hybrid PDFs in LibreOffice.